



Beaver-like tail

All monotremes can swim, but the platypus is especially well adapted—with a flat tail for maneuvering and webbed feet for paddling.

Platypus

Eastern long-beaked echidna

These thick-furred, long-beaked echidnas from central and eastern Papua New Guinea live in mountain forests and alpine grasslands.

Platypus

The platypus needs wetter habitats than those of short-beaked echidnas, so it is confined to the eastern forests where there is open water to swim and feed.

KEY

- Short-beaked echidna
- Western long-beaked echidna
- Eastern long-beaked echidna
- Platypus

Note: the range of Sir David's long-beaked echidna is not visible at this scale.

Coping with cold

In Tasmania—one of the coldest parts of Australia—the platypus stays active even in winter, but the short-beaked echidna spends the winter in hibernation.

Leathery eggs

All monotreme eggs are small and leathery. The platypus lays two grape-sized eggs at a time, while echidnas produce just one. Upon hatching, the babies are then fed with milk, just like all other mammals.



ANIMALS IN DANGER

⚠ The IUCN lists Sir David's long-beaked echidna and the western long-beaked echidna as critically endangered, while the eastern long-beaked echidna is vulnerable and the platypus is near threatened. All of their populations are declining.

**MALE PLATYPUSES HAVE
VENOMOUS SPURS
ON THEIR HIND LIMBS**

